

1944, June 8

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

St. Bonaventure Monastery
1740 Mt. Elliott Ave.
Detroit, Mich.

June 8th 1944

Rev. M. E. Joachim Casey
Mt. Hope, Baltimore, Maryland.

My Dear Brother Maurice, Father Joachim:--

God bless you and yours--
including my poor self I hope. I received your welcome letter
yesterday and, while there is a silent note therein of dis-
satisfaction, that I can hardly be surprized at or blame you
for, yet I am more than pleased and I thank God for what, in my
opinion, must please Heaven better than any success you ever
had--or could have without it--on missions, parishes or catechism
teachings. Thank God for your tone of patient resignation, at
once a great promoter and a fruit of Christian humility. God
himself has provide in your present trying circumstances, a mill
in His wisdom and in His mercy for your refinement in these virtues
that pleas Him most. It seems to me a most hopeful indication if,
notwithstanding your blunders as well as your successes for three
and thirty years in the holy Priesthood--in the brunt of the warfare,
therefore--and especially under your present trying circumstances,
you can still sigh: "Non nobis Domine! non nobis...". Its God and
His holy grace more than anything else that we ought thak. Blessed
be His Holy Name!

About a year ago, on occasion of his 60th anniversary as
a priest the renowned Pastor of Ironton, Ohio--outstanding lecturer
and writer--Father Cotter, told of his saintly and venerated sister
then recently deceased, that when he had come into her presence after
just hearing all kinds of laudations on occasion of his jubilee ten
years before, she earnestly and honestly exclaimed: "O James! How
we ought to thank God that for these fifty years He has never per-
mitted you to/any real scandal."

So dear Brother, Fr. Joachim: let us be grateful to God for
everything--the knocks we get as well as the consolations. ... and
do not blame the Father Chaplain too severely if he seem unduly
exactng, etc. Of all positions he has one that in my opinion must